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Just as one must learn the art of killing in the training for violence, so one must learn the art of dying in the training for non-violence. Violence does not mean emancipation from fear, but discovering the means of combating the cause of fear. Non-violence, on the other hand, has no cause for fear. The votary of non-violence has to cultivate the capacity for sacrifice of the highest type in order to be free from fear.

—M. K. Gandhi

SHANTI SENA IN PERSPECTIVE

● VINOBA

The following is from Vinobaji's inaugural speech at Shanti Sena (Peace Army) rally on the occasion of 15th Sarvodaya Sammelan at Raipur, as the Commander-in-Chief of the army.

I am very pleased at this grand sight—all of us standing with implements of ordinary labour in our hands. The common army has arms of destruction. Our army has also arms but those of construction. These are the arms that will save the world and humanity.

The distinctiveness of man is his two hands, that God has given him to work with. These hands can labour, can give service; they can also protect fellow men. They give *dans* (munificence), they make *pranams* (obeisance). God has given us two long and beautiful hands and a small mouth, but still mankind is in distress.

In the age of science, paradoxically, people are worried over the problem of getting food and clothing for all. There is no reason why it should be so, except that we are working against the spirit of science. Science wants to unite, while by our action, we bring discord and disharmony between men.

The assemblage gathered here is an assemblage for unity, for toil and work, for service. The men in this assemblage are pledged to lay down their lives smilingly, if need be, in the cause of peace and to stop riots. At the same time they have nothing but good at their heart for the rioters.

We who are present here, have love and compassion for all. This power is given to man by God. One gets the power of compassion and it rises from within one's inner being. We desire and firmly believe that if this power is indispensable for the present age, we will get it from within us. Let us see in every soul our own image. There is



The Peace Army on the march with its commander Vinoba Bhave at the vanguard

In Restoring Peace To Calcutta

SHANTI SENA TAKES A PLUNGE

This time the Peace Army (Shanti Sena of the Sarvodaya Movement) did take a plunge and a grave risk at that, in disturbed Calcutta. Together with the Shanti Sevaks (servants of peace, the newest institution that Vinobaji added to the Movement while he was in Calcutta) the Peace Army of the City and districts headed by Shri Charu Chandra Bhandari and aided by Shri Sakti Ranjan Bose (Gandhi Smarak Nidhi) and Shri Radhakrishna (Secy. A.B.S.S.) put up formidable front in no time and left a visible impact on the exciting situation. And the front was reinforced by such central leaders as Nabakrushna Choudhuri, Manmohan Choudhuri (President, Sarva Seva Sangh) Narayan Desai (Secretary, Akhil Bharat Shanti Sena Mandal) who rushed to the agonizing city that had bled profusely from fratricide. Later, Jayaprakash Narayan, President of the Shanti Sena Mandal, also arrived and met groups of people. His warm-hearted message and appeal contributed much to the restoration of communal understanding and harmony.

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something in us that gives us and will give us strength. If we have a firm faith in our inner strength, the glory will be ours. I hope and believe that more groups having this faith and conviction will emerge in

every part of the world and the day is not far off when hands will be joined in mutual help and cooperation. The day is coming when people will no longer break each other's heads.

Notes & Views

THE MONSTER AND ITS VICTIMS

The communal monster has once again reared its ugly head in the two Bengals. Attacks on the minority community began in East Bengal following the theft of the sacred relic from Hazratbal. The relic was retrieved, but by then the virus of communalism had spread to West Bengal. What followed is known to all.

There is a universal feeling that inasmuch as the communal troubles in Calcutta and other parts of West Bengal were a natural repercussion (indeed?) of the ugly happenings in East Pakistan, we are, after all, not as much to blame for it as would be under other circumstances.

This self-righteous other-party-is-to-blame attitude does not hold water for a second. While Pakistan has no pretensions to being a secular State—in fact she openly calls herself an Islamic State—we wax eloquent on our secularism which, we persuade ourselves to believe, permits of no discrimination based on caste, creed or religious differences. The Calcutta riots have only exposed our weakest spot and shown that we have to go a long way before secularism becomes a part of our life, thought and action.

There is an attempt to explain away the disturbanceness as not at all being communal but as hooliganism of some trouble-shooters and goonda elements. To take such a view of the situation is to be deliberately blind to reality. There are said to be some 300 goondas in Calcutta. But the number of those who actually took part in the riots was many times that figure and most of them were not professional goondas. And those who gave them tacit support, believing this was the way to avenge the sufferings of the minority in East Pakistan, must be many more indeed.

The plain thing is, in whatever way Pakistan may treat a section of its own people, we in India cannot and shall not allow ourselves to be carried away by passion to commit brutalities on our minorities who are as much Indian citizens as we are.

At the same time it must be said that people in general are not communal but many among them provided shelter to members of the other community—both Hindu and Muslim—even at the risk of their lives. More than the police and the military, credit goes to them for the fact that the riot did not spread to other parts of the State, save Calcutta, 24 Parganas and Nadia and for the rapid return to normalcy.

Studying the course of events in Calcutta, some salient points stand out prominently. First, the rioters

indulged more in looting and arson than in anything else. And, as happens in such cases, once looting started, even Hindu shops were not spared, because looters have no religion and they do not discriminate between Hindus and Muslims.

Secondly, and this has far-reaching social consequences, the people who indulged in looting and other crimes, were for the most part, people belonging to the middle class. We witnessed teenagers and even children take part in looting as if it were great fun. Their elders, where they were not themselves participants, gave them moral or should we say immoral?—support. The greatest danger is posed by this new class of rising goondas who have lost all moorings. Unless effective measures are taken to purge them of their antisocial habits, they will create a vast underworld of crime and vice and pose a serious problem to the maintenance of law and order.

Thirdly, a large number of cases of arson may perhaps be blamed on certain vested interests who resorted to this easy method of getting rid of their tenants whom they could not evict through legal means.

Fourthly, the role of the Police during the first few days of the disturbances demands a thorough probe. To call them inactive is to put it mildly and very mildly at that. Indeed, it is widely believed that if the Police did their duty, they could nip the troubles in the bud and there would be no need to call out the Army.

Rehabilitation of displaced persons have begun and must be completed expeditiously. Full compensation has to be paid to the affected persons so that they may be resettled in their vocations. But the greatest need of the hour is for all who swear by secularism to address themselves to the task of ruthlessly stamping out the virulent virus of communalism from our body politic once for all

—Barun Das Gupta

Shanti Sena Takes A Plunge

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It is needless to point out, unlike the role of various groups of relief workers belonging to different welfare

institutions and political organizations, the service rendered by Shanti Sainiks bore a deeper meaning and significance. They also rescued the stabbed, burnt and stranded, but what was fundamentally more the stamp of fearlessness and freedom from the last trace of communalism that characterized their attitude was at once creative,—creative of the consciousness that the root of the disease lay deep underneath this surface flare-up. Nothing short of radical socio-economic reforms at the base, i.e. at the commonman-level, could rid the body politic of this paralysing cancer of gangsterism, this violent periodical shock to the social fabric. Even after conceding the desperate and drastic remedy, suggested by certain quarters, of transfer of population on communal basis, the menace of jealousy and hatred will continue to haunt civic life and the only new feature will be that Hindus will break the heads of Hindus, and Muslims will break the heads of Muslims. In either case the corpse goes to the morgue and not to the mosque or the temple!

It must be clearly understood once for all that there is no short cut to the stabilisation of peace in cities like Calcutta where population explosion, sub-human conditions of housing, absence of honourable means of living for millions threaten to wipe out even the last grace of human civilization. The small groups of Shanti Sainiks with yellow turbans and armlets provided this big pointer. Woe betide the Administrations that ostrich-like bury their heads in the sand of palliatives to escape this stark reality. We can ignore the repeated warning of Gandhi and Vinoba that without the backbone of a constructive programme our non-violence and peace formulae are sure to fail miserably at testing times, only to our wanton detriment. Doles and bullets, however liberal and mighty, can never be a substitute for man-making, for economic and social justice, in the denial of which Pakistan has already acquired a notoriety.

So far as the Sarvodaya workers are concerned, two prime lessons stand out prominently from the present situation, viz., our death-defying squads are too small in number to bear the brunt of a major disturbance, and we lack the requisite moral foothold which alone can give us a mighty handle to prevent or quickly put down an explosion. It is high time to seek out the more sensitive spots in the Metropolitan map and identify ourselves with the lot of the local people through the agency of constructive programme.

Mankumar Sen

Shanti Sena Faces The Task With Confidence

• Narayan Desai

Secretary, Shanti Sena Mandal

The present activities of the All India Shanti Sena (Peace Army set up by Vinoba Bhave in 1957) are three fold : (i) it has its network of Shanti Sena Centres in various parts of the country, (ii) it has its special activities in the border areas of North and East, and (iii) it has its training activities.



Narayan Desai

For a couple of hours they carry out some service activity (cleaning the streets, bathing the children, teaching the adults etc. etc.), read some literature connected with peace, eat together, play and disperse. In some parts the Shanti Sena Centres are sowing the seeds of creating a new and selfless leadership among the villagers. More than 300 such peace centres have been formed so far and efforts are being made to activate the existing centres and forming new ones.

Work in Border Areas : The Shanti Sena has 103 Shanti Sena centres in the border areas of NEFA, Assam, North Bengal, Bihar, U. P., Himachal Pradesh and Punjab. The objectives of the Shanti Sena Centres in the border areas are as follows :

- A. To create a spirit of fraternity between the people of the border areas and the rest of India.

- D. To build the strength of non-violent resistance in case there is aggression.

The programme of the Shanti Sena centres differ from place to place. But it generally consists of three items : (1) Getting acquainted with the masses (learning the local dialects knowing the social customs etc) (2) Service activity (Improvement of agriculture, Industries, Health and Education) and (3) building up non-violent strength (training in fearlessness, awareness of the situation, preparing for non-violent non-cooperation etc.)

Training of Peace Volunteers :

The Shanti Sena Mandal has three training Centres in Northern, Central and Southern India. Besides the regular training centres, there is a chain of short courses in what we call 'Shibirs' (training camps) in various parts of the country. We hope to supplement the training programme by starting correspondence courses, sending reading material to groups of Shanti Sainiks and other such activities. The head office has also published handbooks for Shanti Sainiks and Shanti Sena Instructors.

Shanti Sena Organization :

While the whole government and most of the non-government propaganda machinery has been busy encouraging the war effort, it is interesting to note that the Shanti Sena movement has steadily grown during the last year. The number of Sainiks (peace volunteers) which was about 2,000 for the first five years since the formation of the Shanti Sena, has now risen to over 5,000. 14 out of the 18 states have their own state level Shanti Sena organized during the last two years. The most interesting feature of this organization is now becoming the Shanti Kendras (Peace Centres), places where a small number of Shanti Sainiks, (from half a dozen to two dozens) gather regularly, have their prayers or meditation, discuss the situation of the locality and take measures of preventing unrest, wherever there is some cause for trouble.



Shanti Sainiks on way to the work-centre after the Rally at Raipur.

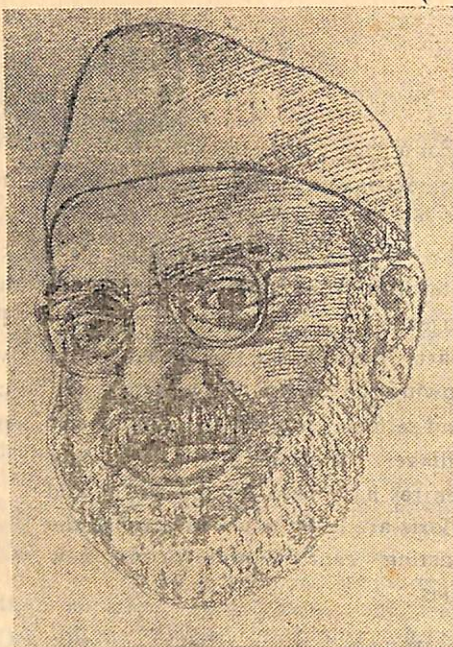
- B. To serve the people by doing 'constructive work'.
- C. To create a spirit of fearlessness among the people by living with them,

The task that we face is tremendous. But the little work that we have been able to do so far, encourages us to face the task with confidence and determination.

J. C. KUMARAPPA

● G. Ramachandran

Most of us in India either worship or forget our leaders who are no more. There seems to be ordinarily no half way house in our minds. We worship Gandhi and forget many others. Among the latter is the late veteran village economist and the greatest devotee of villagism in India. It is now more than three years since he passed away in the General Hospital at Madras. He is not a man we should forget if we are sincere to rebuild village life in India. Next only to Gandhiji and in some ways even more than Gandhiji, he dedicated every hour of his life to think, plan and act for village India. He was not an emotionalist. He was a realist. He lived in no dream-world. He knew the facts about our villages as few other men. Luckily he was trained in the scientific methods of the West and he applied these methods to his study of village India.



J. C. Kumarappa

Greatest Devotee Of Villagism

He was convinced that there was no greater reality in India than the village. The village had been there for uncounted centuries and was going to remain there as long as the human eye could reach. He knew very well that a fraction of the village people will march into towns and cities. But he knew even more that the village will continue to remain at the core of India holding and sustaining millions of our people on the soil and close to the soil. These millions would continue to be the backbone of India. It was in this spirit he wanted all of us to take care of our villages. He was no enemy of towns and cities but with last breath he warned us not to allow towns and cities to exploit the villages and to fatten at their expense. He was not so much worried at what is often called class conflict in society. What worried him more was the widening gap between villages and towns in India and this he knew must lead to conflict unless wise planning took place. He had bitter words to say against our National Planning Commission. He said they were playing with fire. He raged against the idea of villages full of toilers and producers and the towns full of consumers and even profiteering at the expense of the former. He never could tolerate the idea of the one way traffic between the villages and towns under which the towns gained everything and the villages lost everything. He wanted

towns and villages to respect, protect and strengthen each other. He firmly believed this could be done under wiser National Planning.

Dr. J. C. Kumarappa was the man who put the concept and theory of villagism on an unassailable scientific basis. Villagism was no passing phase. It was real and worthwhile in itself. He thought those people stupid who held the view that every village must some day become part of a town. He wanted the towns to pay back fully in human services for everything that the villages gave to the towns. He not only gave us the concept of villagism but taught us the many practices which could make that concept a living reality. He therefore drew up programmes of research, training and nation-wide extension in the field of rural reconstruction. To him villagism was an integrated way of life in the rural areas. There was nothing petty or reactionary about it. In fact the truth was he was so much of a revolutionary that people sometimes thought he had gone completely red. He was certainly a radical rural economist but he never wavered in his loyalty to non-violence. His non-violence was not an excuse to run away from the practice of complete justice to every human being and to him

Keep Erect When You Make Pranams

Wherever I go people come running to make *pranams* (obeisance). Sometimes Shanti Senas also come (though not wearing their yellow turbans). But I want to stop this practice. The sentiment behind it is very good but it creates confusion and wastes time. Bowing is not good. Humility should be at heart. Its outward demonstration weakens and does not strengthen it. I am not saying this specially for the Shanti Sainiks but in a general way. Let the Shanti Sainiks educate people on the method of making *pranams*, which should be like an erect staff and not a fallen staff. By bringing a change in the method of *pranams*, we shall save time and help the country stand erect, its loin girded up and chest expanded. We should thus stand up in manliness. Hunters say when a tiger comes it looks into a man's eyes. If the man is afraid or trembles, the tiger pounces on him: if not, if it finds the man fearless and with a massive chest, it leaves him alone. We should cultivate such fearlessness. This is an easily practicable suggestion that I give you.—Vinoba

[Raipur, 27. 12. 63]

complete economic justice was the only state of society consistent with non-violence. Towards the end of his life he almost came to the conclusion that most Gandhians were taking cover under non-violence to justify inaction. When he found that S. Jagannathan was determined upon making non-violence into instrument of revolutionary action he took the young man to his heart and nourished him. Jagannathan would not be as lonely as he is today if Kumarappaji were with us still.

What is needed today is not to repeat every word of this prophet of villagism or even to accept all his thoughts as such. What is needed is to take this great comrade of ours far more seriously and to study him far more carefully. We cannot dismiss him as irrelevant in time or in substance. Above all, we must never forget. No man in our generation gave more than he did for the cause of villagism. We shall be honouring ourselves in honouring the memory of this great son of India. Luckily for all of us he passed away on a 30th of January, the same day on which Gandhiji also left us. The Master and the Disciple were thus not only one in life but equally in death.

Socialism & Sarvodaya

(Continued from the last issue)

[Tall talks of socialism are on the air. But such talks are often confusing and create more problems. Which way lies socialism? J. P. answers this most urgent question while presenting the logic of gramdan, with his characteristic brevity, as the inevitable basis of socialism in India. He urges the major political parties to work exclusively for Gramdan for only two months to create the requisite atmosphere.—Ed.]

Jayaprakash Narayan

The New Form of Gramdan

Formerly, Gramdan required that 80% of the landowners vest their land in the Gramsabha and the total land donated be at least 50% of the total arable land of the village. The Gram Sabha redistributed the entire land. The total quantity of land was divided by the total number of donees and the average distributed to each individual family. This ideal form of land distribution was, however, seldom observed in practice. The big landowners became afraid and apprehensive. The movement failed to make advance.

As there is no room for fear in a movement of love, Vinobaji has now introduced 'Sulabh Gramdan' in which all landowners vest 80% of their land in the Gramsabha. Socialism demands social ownership of the means of production. Gramdan is just that because in it the ownership of land vests neither in the State, nor in the political parties nor in the Central Government, but in the village community. It is a far humane form of ownership.

With the title vesting in the Gramsabha, the landowner cannot mortgage or sell his land though he remains in possession of the land he donated. It is he who tills his land and earns his livelihood. He makes an outright gift of 1/20th (one katha per bigha) of his land to the landless. A landowner contributes 1/40th (one seer in a maund) of the produce and a serviceholder or a labourer contributes a day's earning in the month to the common Village Fund to be utilized for the welfare of the community.

Thus, capital goes on accumulating in the village fund. The shelterless gets the first preference in the utilization of the fund, the unemployed coming next who are provided gainful occupation in village industries. Loans are made available from this fund to the deserving and the needy. In this way the village becomes a self-sufficient self-reliant unit, collective strength increases, and villagers learn to work shoulder to shoulder.

A Four-Pillared Society

Gram Swarajya will be a four-pillared society. The first pillar will be the Gram Sabha comprising

of one member from every family, each thinking for the other. People will think and act collectively in all matters of common concern. In keeping with Sarvodaya principle, all disputes will be settled by unanimous decision or by arbitration. No decision will be valid unless taken unanimously.

The second pillar will be the vesting of land by all landowners to the Gramsabha.

The third pillar will be the gift by the landowners of 1/20th (one katha per bigha) of their land to the landless.

The fourth pillar will be the contribution of 1/40th (one seer per maund) of produce or one day's earning in a month to the common Village Fund.

We have to begin the work of village development with the resources available in the village. We have to draw up schemes for the development of village industries. We have to popularize the idea of using only articles manufactured in the village.

Gramdan and Three Major Parties

Gramdan is socialism of agricultural countries, where it cannot be ushered in either by force or by law. The central theme of Gramdan is love and goodwill. I believe if the three major political parties of the country viz: the Congress, the P.S.P. and the Socialist Party, give their undivided attention exclusively to Gramdan for two months they can create an atmosphere highly favourable to Gramdan. They can get at least one and a half lakhs of Gramdan, which will have a tremendous impact on trade and commerce, on business, on capitalism. And when the task of village reconstruction is undertaken in all Gramdani villages, the true and ennobling power of socialism will unfold itself. Socialism is the first step to Sarvodaya. The bird of socialism has two wings, State power and the power of the people and it can soar in the wide blue sky only by means of these two wings.

[Based on a talk given to the 6th Conference of Bihar State Proja Socialist Party at Kishanganj on 24th November, 1963]

(Concluded)

GANDHI CENTENARY DISCUSSED

Calcutta, Jan. 10, 1964, Leading Gandhi-ites of Bengal, belonging to different Khadi institutions, recently met to discuss how Gandhiji's birth centenary in 1969 could be celebrated in Bengal in a befitting way. The meeting, attended among others by Shri P. C. Sen, Chief Minister and Shri Charu Chandra Bhandari, Sarvodaya leader, was convened by Dr. P. C. Ghose, Chairman, Gandhi Smarak Nidhi, Bengal Branch, at his Lokabharaati Kendra at Barbasudebpur (Midnapur).

Dr. Ghose as Convener of the meeting said the Khadi institutions of Bengal should work together in preparing for Gandhi centenary celebrations. He hoped this meeting would be the first step in bringing the Gandhian workers and organizations of Bengal on a common platform for this purpose.

Shri Sakti Bose, Secretary of the Bengal Branch of the Nidhi, placed a draft programme for discussion.

Shri P. C. Sen felt happy at the get-together of the old workers of the Gandhian movement and said such meetings should be periodically held. They served a useful purpose, he said, by providing an opportunity for exchange of thoughts and ideas.

The draft programme prepared by Shri Bose was discussed. The consensus of opinion was that by 1969 a fund of 50 lakh rupees should be raised mainly through small contributions from common people, Gandhi literature in Bengali worth at least a lakh of rupees be sold, recruitment and training of workers undertaken, and a series of lectures by eminent social workers, economists, philosophers, etc., on different aspects of Gandhism be arranged. The Gandhi Smarak Nidhi would take the initiative in collaboration with all Gandhian workers of Bengal.

Among those attended were Dr. Nripen Bose (Abhay Ashram), Sm. Purabi Mukherjee, State Health Minister, Sm. Tarakha Sen (Khadi Pratishthan), Shri Sailesh Banerjee (Khadi Commission), and Sm. Amalprova Das, Sarvodaya leader of Assam.

—(S.P.S.)

Abhinav Gramdan

Sarvodayapuri, Dec. 28.—Making appreciative reference to Shri Charu Chandra Bhandari's (West Bengal) approach to the present version of Gramdan and disapproval of the same being called 'Sulabh' easy, Acharya Vinoba Bhawe said at the Sammelan this afternoon that he had also been thinking that hereafter we should call it 'abhinav' Gramdan and not 'Sulav' Gramdan. (S.P.S.)

*At The Raipur Sammelan**Gerhard Tschannerl Reports*

Friendship March

When two parties are in conflict it usually happens that each feels in the right. I have personal experience of this twenty years ago when my country, Austria, was engrossed in the Second world war. Like so many other people I believed without doubt that England and France were threatening the very existence of Germany and Austria, and that we were fighting a righteous war against a wicked enemy.

The two countries India and China are in a similar situation. It is in this context that the Friendship March tried to raise some questions, to some of which I hope to direct your thoughts.

The main emphasis of the March is the establishment of a climate of friendship between the two countries. For this there is need for knowledge of each others. The Indian people, on the one hand, get a very negative picture of China, from the reports in newspapers and on the radio. In our discussions some people have even compared the behaviour of Chinese people with that of snakes and tigers. I am convinced that the Chinese want peace just as ardently as all the other peoples in the world. Yet the Indian people get the impression that the contrary is true. I am grieved to see that all Chinese publications are barred from Indian soil. Not even a map of China can be bought.

Another stumbling block for the good relations between the two countries are the military preparations on either side. The military establishments that can be found in all the countries of the world are sad demonstrations of our mistrust against each other. Even negotiations between governments are strongly influenced by the presence of the military which can be used as the ultimate sanction. The Indian people are worried about the situation at the border. They ask for guidance. Their government comforts them with the only kind of solution that governments have known: To build up a strong military.

During our discussion meetings—and especially in Assam—people have asked repeatedly: "We agree with you that military preparations are not a constructive solution; but what else can we do? We cannot

just sit back and do nothing." We remind them of something which they have often forgotten, that is Gandhiji's nonviolent programme through which that India got independence. People often think for a moment and they say, "Yes, perhaps that could be the way."

However, I am thankful to the government of India permitting the Friendship March to walk through India for eight months, publicly expressing its disagreement with the government's military policy. But the effects of war preparations reach deep into people's lives. And this is already evident in India. In the United States, a country with which I am somewhat familiar, there is hardly any factory that is not in some way working for the military. This leads to industrial management trying to please the military. Industry in turn has a strong say in American politics. Can we say: What does this matter? It matters because in this way the nuclear arms race is sustained, and because the people have increasingly less to say.

One thing that the March has always been criticised for its reluctance to call China the aggressor. We have tried to study the border situation and from whatever little facts we could find we could not conclude that one party is completely right and the other one completely at fault. We find this argument about the history of the conflict immaterial. When one wants to create a friendly climate between the two peoples, one that would be conducive to the peaceful settlement of the dispute, it does not help at all to call one side the aggressor.

While one realizes the harmfulness of military preparations, and as the necessity of training in nonviolent action, young men are compelled to undergo rifle training. If I returned to Austria now there would be an effort to conscript me into the army, despite my having been in various nonviolent projects.

When military preparations are not the way, then what is the way to solve international conflicts? Preventing conflicts through the establishment of more nonviolent society is one way. The Sarvodaya movement with its programmes of Bhoodan and Gramdan is pioneering in this field. A great number of people all over the world look to the Sarvodaya movement for guidance to show the way to lasting peace. In search of an alternative to Communism, many find Sarvodaya the only satisfactory answer.

While we are in the process of preparing a more nonviolent society, conflicts could arise. And once a nonviolent society has been established, we can never expect it to be

China Offended by J. P.'s Statement

Sarvodayapuri, Dec. 24,—Sbri Jayaprakash Narayan disclosed here today that China did not allow Delhi-Peking Friendship March initiated by Akhil Bharat Shanti Sena Mandal, to enter China because he was the President of the Mandal.

Addressing the annual session of the Sarva Seva Sangh, the Sarvodaya leader further said that his statement in respect of China's aggression on Tibet had offended China, but he still felt that China did commit aggression on Tibet and that was true.

Regarding the Friendship March, J. P. observed that it had created a good atmosphere and had certainly boosted the morale of the people in Assam and other areas. (S. P. S.)

so absolutely nonviolent that there will be no conflicts at all from then on. The army in India is preparing now for a possible future outbreak of fighting. Similarly, I feel, a nonviolent army should prepare. Naturally I hope very much that fighting at the border will not break out again, and I do not think it will. When the nonviolent army is prepared and then there is no fighting, the nonviolent soldier can stay in potential conflict area and serve the people. He can work for better relations between the country and her neighbors, and can help in the building of a nonviolent socialist society. He does not have to wait for fighting to start, unlike the violent soldier who is only getting ready for combat on the battle field.

It is a great thing that the shanti sena has taken up work at the border and is sending shanti sainiks into the area. I would have liked every one who is working for peace to see the impressive shanti sena rally yesterday. Even if this had been the only thing that happened at the sammelan I would feel completely rewarded for coming here.

The Friendship March has tried to communicate with China. We have found that at this moment we cannot get the permission to enter. If no favourable response will come forth from China, this March will be terminated at the end of January. I do not look upon this as a defeat. I feel that we are one cell of a large body, the world peace movement. The World Peace Brigade and the Indian Shanti Sena will have to continue efforts to lessen China's isolation in the world community and to establish an atmosphere which would be conducive to a peaceful and friendly relationship between India and China. At the closing conference of the March at the end of January we want to explore areas of further work and possibilities of new projects in this direction.

Jawaharlal Nehru, India And Socialism

Suresh Ram

SOCIALISM is the resounding call of this scientific age. No politician can avoid it, none in authority can evade it. With most of them, however, it is a convenient slogan to entrench themselves in power and ignore the realities facing them. With Jawaharlal Nehru it has been a sacred mantra which he has been earnestly and ceaselessly pleading before the Indian people for the last forty years and more. One meets his socialist stamp first in the resolutions of the United Provinces Provincial Congress Committee in the twenties and later on in those of the All-India Congress Committee. And when he firmly dwelt on the need of socialism in his Presidential address before the Lucknow Congress in 1936, it created a furore inasmuch as some leading members of the Working Committee threatened to resign because of his "preaching and emphasising" socialism. Jawaharlal was unmoved and within a few months, when he addressed the nation again from the same tribune at Faizpur, he made a prophetic declaration :

"I hope the logic of events will lead to Socialism; for, that seems to me the only remedy for India's economic ills."

Yet, he did not press further. For a slave country has to secure independence before it can aspire for socialism or anything else. India, though truncated, attained freedom on August 15, 1947 and became a Sovereign Democratic Republic on January 26, 1950. The road was then clear. At the Avadi Congress in 1955, Jawaharlal Nehru moved the historic resolution for "the establishment of a socialistic pattern of society". During these eight years and a half, Socialism has become the official creed of the nation and has attracted the attention of all thinking minds.

But what about the masses? To them, our unlettered brethren who have never known a full meal, socialism has not meant much change. A sixth of India's population consists of the landless labour whose average per capita income is below hundred rupees, about a third of the national average. Except for less than five per cent of those at the top, Socialism stands to all others for more taxation and higher prices and greater pressure from above. It became an instrument with the rich and powerful, with alarmingly little concern for ethical proprieties, to build their own fortunes and crush all below with a merciless hand. None could be unhappier than Jawaharlal Nehru at this strange development in Indian planning and politics. A curious spectacle meets the eye: Congress is wedded to Socialism, while Congressmen are divorced from it.

Honestly, they are not at fault. Though it would be unwise to shackle Socialism to a rigid formula, they are not very much aware of its contents. They were asked, as it were, to believe in Socialism, but were given no programme for it. Theirs was to support the doings (or misdoings?) of the administration and to take no lead of their own. Naturally, they began to interpret Socialism as composed of three elements:

- (a) Change of individual ownership by that of the State;
- (b) Replacement of people's initiative by the law of the State;
- (c) Ultimate reliance on brute force or armed might.

But they could not assimilate these tenets and failed to adopt them in practice. In the name of Socialism, they found a good many of their colleagues fulfilling their appetite for power and wealth, taking no risk, nor undergoing any suffering or sacrifice. It just did not appeal to their heart, though their mind was agreeable to it in theory. Moreover, they had been bred and brought up in different traditions whose pillars were:

- (a) Trusteeship of ownership;
- (b) Evolution of people's self-reliant strength;
- (c) Ultimate reliance on non-violent non-cooperation or soul-force.

And here lies the rub. Heavily pre-occupied with the responsibilities of office, Jawaharlal Nehru

could not place a clear-cut and well-defined image of Socialism before his party and the nation. All agree that we must have a society free from disparities and exploitation and coercion, but how to attain it?—through the socialistic traditions and institutions grown in the West or will India set up her own norms and moulds? Above all, we have the question whether legislation alone will serve the purpose and whether Congressmen have but to follow in its footsteps. Congress has not cared to go into these details. As it has confined itself to oracular pronouncements without translating them into practical meaning, one is led to assume that it stands by the Western model of Socialism and is guided by its values and sanctions. Be as it may, it could not carry the process to the desired length and had to adopt such an unenviable course as resulted in a distortion of Socialism, greater concentration of wealth in fewer hands, and loss of its momentum and sense of purpose.

This state of affairs must go. Let us cry a halt to this sad process. The time has now come when the details of the socialistic procedure should be clearly laid before the people. Jawaharlal Nehru owes it both to Socialism and the country not to allow any confusion or ambiguity or to let people indulge themselves in self-delusion. They want to know whether they should encourage class-war (as also class-hatred which is its natural ally), substitute individual ownership by that of the State, and enforce legislation relentlessly to reach their objective. There is no middle way to Socialism, as taught during the last hundred years by its exponents from Marx to Wilson.

But if law could accomplish Socialism, we would have a socialist utopia by now in several countries. We have not. For, law has its limitations, and severe limitations. It can deprive an owner of his or her property but cannot compel him or her to share it with the neighbour. In other words, law can fabricate the socialist structure, but it cannot generate the socialistic climate and temper. It can provide us with Socialism in letter but not in spirit. It is not law or coercion, but change of heart or conversion that can infuse the socialistic spirit in the society. But the very word 'conversion' is anathema in socialist circles. Little wonder that socialism has not very much succeeded in the West and is not delivering the goods in India with the desired speed. Socialism cannot be obtained as a mechanical outcome of an economic planning, but as a consummation of educative process, breaking old barriers of custom and tradition and thought and creating a new mind

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Kennedy's Martyrdom—A Pointer

• Vinoba

Today I heard on the Radio that President Kennedy was assassinated by a youth of twenty-four. It was a very painful news. These days he was working hard for the cause of peace. He acquitted himself with much tact, and displayed considerable pluck when emergency arose. What draws our attention most is that he was sincerely working for peace. This unfortunate event is a blow to the world peace. Of late there had been better understanding between Krushchev and Kennedy, for which credit goes to both sides; and it was hoped that they would come closer day by day. To China, Kennedy went to the extent of saying that U. S. A. was prepared to change its thinking about it and reshape its attitude provided it agreed to be at peace with other countries. It is apparent from this that the whole of his thought was in the direction of peace. The assassination of such a man amounts to a fatal blow to the best in man.

It is said that the assassin's gun was mounted with a telescope. What sort of arm was it? It was not a nuclear weapon, the conventional weapon did the havoc. It is because of this that for the last several years I have been repeating that non-violence has no danger from nuclear weapons. They are destructive but not violent. They are capable of devastation on a vast scale; they pose a big problem for man and thus compel him to ponder. He then begins to think in the direction of non-violence. Thus what is dangerous is small arms—the lathi, the sword, the knife, the gun. They stand completely arraigned against non-violence. Nuclear weapons are awe-inspiring but do not suffer from pettiness. Sometimes good results from awe, for it compels man to think, think in an altogether new direction, that of non-violence. It is in this way that Krushchev and Kennedy and other great men of the world began to think in terms of peace. What led them to do so was the awe-inspiring nuclear weapon.

During the last 10-12 years in our country, there have been riots at many places and ugly incidents, some in the name of language or religion and others in the name of labour's and students' interests. This adversely influenced the country's mind and tarred its picture. That is why I had to remark that I am afraid of the petty arms and not of the nuclear weapons. When such a shocking occurrence takes place, one loses balance. But it is on such occasions that we should keep up equanimity of mind.

Another reason why Kennedy's passing away pained me was that he put his whole heart on reducing global poverty and disparity. A very great man working on such a scale has been the target of an assassin's bullet. The world is poorer by his death. What should we do to prevent the repetition of such a calamity? It is a pointer directing us that we all should work from bottom upwards. Then will man throw away arms. Let us use our hands for increasing production and if we do this in co-operation with one another, the major problems that face humanity will be solved. Want and disparity must go and with them will vanish other problems too by and by. No doubt petty difficulties will remain but that will go on in human evolution, to push man's growth further. But the problem of hollow-bottomed dinner pail must be solved first (I call it Kaliyug). To my mind, the hour has come now. A new era will dawn, the millennium, on earth. Such ugly events will then be a thing of the past. The sooner we put an end to Kaliyug, the earlier will be the advent of Satyayug. We should forget such event, as if they never occurred. It is not difficult for the people of India. It has a great tradition of unity which is in their very grain. It is dormant there. Only it has to germinate and take root in the life of the people. That it can be brought about now is my hope.

Bhainsa

Orrissa

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Jawaharlal Nehru, India And Socialism

(Continued from page 303)

and a new man. For this we have to build up, in the light of the experience of the past sixteen years, a Socialism of our own which, instead of being a replica of the West, will have its own framework and special characteristics. In the words of Gandhiji:

"Socialism and communism of the West are based on certain conceptions which are fundamentally different from ours. One such conception is their belief in the essential selfishness of the human nature. I do not subscribe to it for I know that the essential difference between man and the

"The West Has Misunderstood Shanti Sena"

—J. P.

Sarvodayapuri, Dec. 24,—
"Those of the West who are working for peace through non-violence have misunderstood the position and approach of the Shanti Sena. (Peace Army) in India vis-a-vis Chinese aggression", remarked Shri Jayaprakash Narayan at the Annual Conference of the Sarva Seva Sangh, this evening.

J. P. reiterated his conviction that India could not stop war permanently by war, hence his plea for unilateral disarmament and non-violent resistance. The Shanti Sena in India sought to create such an atmosphere in which the people would demand of the Prime Minister, whosoever he might be, to disband the army. (S.P.S.)

brute is that the former can respond to the call of the spirit in him, can rise superior to the passions that he owns in common with the brute and, therefore, superior to selfishness and violence, which belong to the brute nature and not to the immortal spirit of man. Our socialism or communism should, therefore, be based on non-violence and on harmonious co-operation of labour and capital, landlord and tenant."

Bhhoodan

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Observe January 30 As...

The Shanti Sena Mandal has appealed that January 30 be celebrated as Peace Day all over India. The programme envisaged for the day includes organising marches and rallies in various places and obtaining signatures from citizens on a Peace Pledge.

WORLD PEACE DAY

• RADHAKRISHNA

The Pledge runs as follows :

"I, as a citizen of India, affirm my faith in the universal principle of civilized society, namely, that every dispute between citizens or groups, institutions or organisations of citizens should be settled by peaceful means, and, in view of the current danger to the integrity and unity of the country, I hereby pledge myself never to resort to violence in the case of any dispute, whether in my neighbourhood or in any other part of India."

It has also been suggested that individuals might miss a meal and donate the savings for the Indian Peace movement. For a number of years the people of India have celebrated this day as Martyrs' Day and observed silence for two minutes at 11 A. M., wherever they might be.

Whereas the programme has been suggested for all citizens in common, specific suggestions are made to members and friends of the Sarvodaya fellowship.... They include :—

- a) conducting Peace Marches ;
- b) organising mass spinning ;
- c) arranging programmes of distribution of land in the context of the Bhoodan movement ;
- d) undertaking campaigns of public sanitation ;
- e) selling peace badges ;
- f) selling peace literature ;
- g) forming local peace committees to take responsibility for maintaining peace in their respective areas ;
- h) encouraging youth to start Youth Peace Corps as a substitute to N.C.C. ;
- i) organising work camps ;
- j) propagating the idea of arbitration for settlement of local disputes ;
- k) establishing centres of study of Gandhian and other Sarvodaya literature ;
- l) arranging meetings of people of different religious affiliations ;
- m) reciting writings of Gandhi to groups of people ; and
- n) preparing placards and posters with Peace slogans and motifs.

The rapid advances in science and the development in means of communication have not only shrunk the size of the world but have rendered useless the techniques of violence for the resolution of conflicts, big or small. The horrors of nuclear war have only increased the imminence of this tragic situation. Mankind is being led to the imperative conclusion that serious and earnest attempts will have to be made to seek alternative to violence and war. It is no mere truism to say that wars are made essentially in the minds of men, and so the seeds of peace have to be sown in their minds. Our task as peace-makers is not only actively exploring alternatives to solving situations of violence and conflict, but to educate the minds of masses of men in methods of constructive peace making and peaceful living. Conflicts have to be taken out from their narrow limitations and viewed from larger dimensions. The Shanti Sena believes that one of its basic tasks is to educate the people about the problems and their consequences and prepare them for active efforts towards lasting peace.

Peace is needed not only because war is difficult, dangerous and derogatory ; but because we still need to "learn to regard national boundaries as no more than conveniences of administration, and to erase from our minds their role as barriers which isolate species of mankind." The motivation for non-violent action is not merely the fear of the disastrous consequences of war and violence because violence disregards and denies the qualities of human excellence. But is in the fact that we desire that human beings live to recognise and respect the common humanity of all races and nations.

The task, however, is not easy. The situation is complicated by the fact that nations have admired and extolled emotions and qualities of character which prepare men individually as heroes of war, as marks of courage and bravery. Attitudes that make for peace should also be derived from the same, perhaps more, strength of character and

(Continued on page 306)

Akhil Bharat Shanti Sena : Programme For The Year 1964

Being in the initial stages of its development, it is not possible to make definite commitments about the Shanti Sena's future programme which, naturally, will be modified according to circumstances. The following programme, for the current year 1964, has been however, formulated by *Akhil Bharat Shanti Sena Mandal* in view of the situation obtaining today :

1. Organization of the Shanti Kendras. They took root in the last year. More Kendras will be set up in the months to come. There is a possibility of new Shanti Kendras being opened in the field where Khadi and Gramdan work is being done. This year a drive to enlist 5000 Shanti Sainiks will be made.

2. Camps will be held at different places to train new Shanti Sainiks and Conveners of the Shanti Kendras.

3. A new step in the peace movement this year will be the setting up of the Kishor Shanti Dal. A beginning has already been made in Gujarat. The aim is to organize 50 such groups in the year.

4. At least one training camp of the commanders of the Kishor Shanti Dals will be held.

5. The Shanti Sena started its work in the border areas last year. This year efforts will be made to expand and consolidate it. Among the new areas proposed to be taken up this year are Pakistan, the border areas, Mizo Hills and if possible Nagaland. 50 new Shanti Kendras are intended to be opened in the border areas.

6. Training facilities will be provided to the Shanti Sainiks required for the purpose.

7. 30th January will be observed as Peace Day.

8. During the Sarvodaya Fort-night, the Shanti Sainiks will undertake padayatra in different regions and collect banks of yarn, enlist Sarvodaya Mitras and install Sarvodaya Patras.

9. Gram Swarajya Week will be observed from 6th to 18th April. The Shanti Sainiks will propagate the programme of Gramdan, New Khadi, and Shanti Sena during the week.

10. The Shanti Kendras will try to create conditions favourable for Gramdan and Khadi work in their respective and neighbouring areas.

DEMOCRATIC SOCIALISM

• Manmohan Choudhuri

The Indian National Congress has, at Bhubaneswar, redefined its objective as "democratic socialism based on democracy, dignity of the human individual and social justice." This replaces the earlier version, defined at Nagpur as "a Socialist Cooperative Commonwealth." Perhaps the earlier definition was vague and the new one is desired to make the declaration of socialist faith more clear and forth-right. Anyway the long resolution making this change spells out the objective in considerable detail and it makes impressive reading. Removal of poverty, reduction of economic disparity, limitation of income and property in private hands, etc. have been clearly laid down as important objectives. There is one definite and important commitment: to ensure a national minimum standard in the provision of the basic needs of food, clothing, housing, education and health for every individual, to be realised substantially by the end of the Fifth Plan.

It stresses the strategic and pre-dominant role the public sector has to play in the field of trade and industry and points out that the private sector also has an important role to play. It is emphasised that the cooperative method of organisation will occupy an increasingly important place, especially in the fields of agriculture, small scale and processing industries and retail trade.

The resolution accepts the importance of decentralised small and cottage industries in the national economy, defines the goal of land reform as "a cooperative rural economy based on the rural community and on voluntary association" and calls for the completion of land reforms within the next two years. It lays down that in respect of education and health the child should receive the first consideration and equality of opportunity should start from the birth of the child so that every child receives the necessary facilities of education according to his capacity,

The resolution takes note of the existence of large amounts of unaccounted money in the hands of unscrupulous individuals and of the need to meet the threat posed by it

by "systematic and strong" action. It also points out the necessity for readjusting and bringing about "radical changes" in the outlook and organisation of the administrative system if the Five Year Plans are to be properly implemented.

Thus the ideals defined and the tasks set are clear and ambitious enough, and from the point of view of Sarvodaya, there is little to which serious objection can be taken, though it will be possible to find out lots of omission in terms of a perfect social ideal. But what one is immediately concerned about is not the delineation of the perfect outline of the ultimate goal but the concrete steps that are proposed to be taken in that direction. From this point of view the resolution is satisfactory enough, provided it is seriously and effectively implemented.

And this has been the real catch in all lofty and ambitious resolves so far made. The will and the energy needed for their implementation somehow failed to materialise. But there are some reasons to hope that this time it may be different. Since sometime there has been a tendency of self-criticism and a readiness to accept short-comings and failures. Since Jaipur the rank and file has evinced a marked unrest and impatience with existing stagnation and drift. Many of the speeches at Bhubaneswar had a ring of serious concern and determination. So we should wait optimistically for the outcome.

As we have pointed out, there is one definite commitment in the resolution, to ensure a national minimum standard by the end of the Fifth Plan, that is in another twelve years.

An eminent economist in the Planning Commission has calculated that the present mode of economic growth can never ensure a minimum per capita income of rupees twenty per month for everybody even in fifty years. The actual experience of the last decade or more goes to confirm this pessimistic forecast. Hence, it will be a stupendous achievement if this one task is fulfilled within the time limit set, unless the minimum standard is defined as something sub-humanly low. This will require far-reaching changes in current economic policies and a resetting of priorities. For it every nerve will have to be strained and a new sense of urgency and expeditiousness that is non-existent today will have to be injected into the entire system. This

task, undertaken in the spirit of "unto this last" will be enough by itself to set the tone of the new social order. Let us hope that the goal will arouse the required enthusiasm and determination in Congressmen. Sarvodaya workers will deem it a privilege to cooperate in the fulfilment of this goal.

We firmly believe that universal implementation of the programme of Gramdan coupled with Khadi and Shanti Sena, is indispensable for the success of this goal of 'unto this last' and lay the foundations of "the cooperative rural economy based on the village community and on voluntary association," as laid down in the resolution. Now that the goal of the Congress has been defined in terms in harmony with the spirit of Sarvodaya, we expect Congressmen to take a greater interest in the implementation of this programme of the Sarvodaya movement. Now really it should be *their* programme. It will also give them a wide scope to put into practice the exhortation that "Congressmen in their everyday life should become examples of this Socialist Philosophy" which so far no other programme offers. And this personal practice and participation is, after all, the acid test of all good intentions.

World Peace Day

(Continued from page 305)

surrender of self. Neither is peace meek submission out of weakness nor can it be waged without cultivating fearlessness and lack of enmity in one's heart. Lasting peace has never been achieved on the basis of avenging defeat or securing victory.

In India, in the last fifteen years we have witnessed the sad spectacle of groups of men losing their balance of mind and taking recourse to acts of violence in the name of a just or idealist cause. It is a long way for us to grow from the rule of jungle through the rule of civility to the rule of love. January 30th has a special significance to us in India and all the world over as it was the day when Gandhi surrendered his life in fulfilment of his life's peace mission. As Vinoba said of him; He was the first volunteer for peace and also its first Commandant. As a Commandant, he gave orders and as a soldier he obeyed it laying down his life."

We hope that the appeal of the Shanti Sena Mandal will have wide response and the people of India would utilize this occasion to consider national and international problems in the dimensions of constructive peace. We are hoping that after the experience of this year, we shall be able to celebrate 30th January as World Peace day in the year to come.

FIRST DECLARATION ON SHANTI SENA

Shanti Sena (Peace Army) first took root on 12th August 1957 at Kozikode in Kerala, where the veteran Satyagrahi of the state, Shri K. Kelappan signed the pledge of Shanti Sena, drafted by Vinobaji, with seven others. The first statement on Shanti Sena, which will go down in history as a call that marked the beginning of a new era and a challenge to the violent organisation that characterizes modern society, is reproduced below :

It is ten years since India has regained her freedom. But we have not yet realized the Grama Rajya of Gandhiji's dream. We could not get any glimpse of it either in the policies or programmes of National Government, or in the routine constructive activities carried on by Gandhiji's followers. It was then that the Bhoodan movement appeared as a silver lining in the all-pervading darkness. After six years of work, Bhoodan has now paved the way for Gramdan. The picture of Gram Raj becomes clearer and clearer as we move forward in the work for Gramdan. Today Gram Raj has ceased to be a fascinating dream ; it is being felt as a reality coming within the reach of experience.

Society today all over the world is being strangled within the framework of government. The full and unfettered growth of the individual is not possible in that set-up. The violence and exploitation that has spread all over are ever on the increase. In order to liberate the individual and society from this and to build up a non-violent social order based on Gramdan, and with a thoroughly new perspective, effective work has to be organised.

A non-violent and non-exploitative society cannot be brought into being either through the legislature or the Government. That revolution can come only from the people. The State and the present social order are upheld by three factors—the consent of the people obtained through the ballot box providing the basis for the political power of the State, the taxes paid by the people enriching the coffers of the State, and the army which embodies the punitive power of the State for the maintenance of law and order.

A Sarvodaya order of society can be built only if these are substituted by their non-violent counterparts. The creative Sammatidan (the giving of consent) should take the place of inactive vote, the Sampattidan and Bhoodan the place of the taxes and Shanti Sena the place of the police and the military. This experiment must start immediately at least in a few selected places. We have to prove that the coercive power of the State is only not inevitable for the maintenance of peace in society, but a normal democracy cannot be built up on that basis. It should be possible for us to get the police and the military withdraw. This is the only way for the realization of a non-violent Sarvodaya Society—the dream of great thinkers.

We have resolved to form a Shanti Sena who are prepared to lay down their lives for this ideal. They should take the pledge enjoined on the Lok Sevaks and for Shanti Sena and to face any situation with a sense of discipline. The five-fold observances are the following :—

1. To strive one's utmost to practise Sathya, Ahimsa, and Aparigraha, i. e. non-possession.
2. To do Nish-kama Seva, i. e. service without a desire for return.
3. To keep aloof from all party or power politics and to try to win the maximum co-operation of all irrespective of party consideration.
4. Not to observe any difference of class or caste and to cultivate equal respect for all religions.
5. To devote one's maximum time and total meditation for Bhoodan.

Lok Sevaks are bound to these pledges. Members of the Shanti Sena will work as Lok Sevaks in normal conditions, but on particular occasions as soldiers.

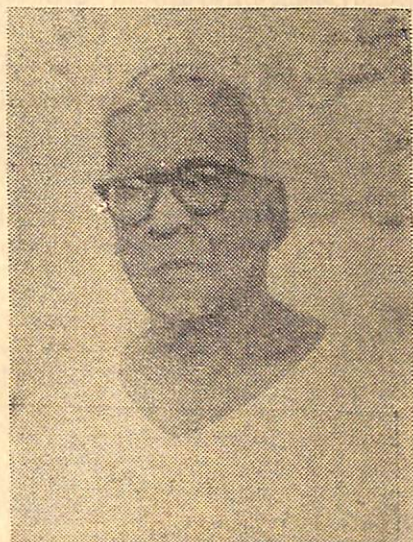
We fully believe that a Sarvodaya Social Order can be built up in India through the efforts of this Shanti Sena. This is a glorious objective inspiring any Indian. We consider ourselves fortunate in being able to constitute the sena under the inspiring guidance of Poojya Vinobaji. We appeal to our country-men to share in this great and noble Yajna and dedicate ourselves to this mighty task.

Peace Journey's End

(Continued from page 308)

They say their arrival at the White House is merely the end of the first phase of their work, and continually they are evolving new

prospects to bring the danger of war home to people and to urge the sanity of an anti-violent approach. Some of their experiences on the last stage of their journey may well have served to strengthen their resolve. Washington of course, is south of



Shri Kelappan, the first Shanti Sainik

the Mason Dimon line, it the line dividing North from South and, traditionally where relative liberalism gives way to bigotry which become increasingly uninhibited as the South is penetrated. For the first time since they left New York the marchers experienced hostility. Not everybody threw snowballs as did an angry father and his son, and not everybody told members of the team who offered them a leaflet they "...didn't want any of that shit", or simply to "fuck off". Most were content to yell imprecations from their cars or to blare their horns.

But such hostility is not the whole story, it was more than matched by the numerous waves and thumbs up signalling from passing truck and car drivers, as well as by the almost embarrassingly frequent offers of coffee from other wellwishers. In Washington itself the team was provided with a police escort. Said one burley cop : "If you want directions or if anyone tries to molest you, just signal our car behind and we'll help or protect you. That's what we are here for", which is as pretty a speech as any peace marcher is likely to hear from a sergeant policeman anywhere. I wonder if it may be accounted for in part though I hope not by the fact that the sergeant in question was a Negro ?

Notice

Ca cutta's disturbances having upset our work, this issue of BHOODAN appears behind the schedule and the series on Community Development & Social Change are held over.

January 25, 1964

The International Peace March by E. P. Menon and Satish Kumar, two vigorous Indian youths associated with the Sarvodaya Movement, has now ended. It will be recalled they launched the March on June 1, 1962, from Gandhi Memorial, Rajghat, Delhi, armed with the blessings of Acharya Vinoba Bhave on whose advice they travelled without money), Dr. S. Radhakrishnan, President of India, Prime Minister Nehru and thousands of their colleagues engaged in the quest of peace besides a cheering message from Bertrand Russell. "All nations, big and small alike, must declare unilateral and total disarmament", they declared and pressed home to numerous friends and admirers, critics and statesmen throughout their hazardous trek of over 7000 miles during which they passed through Pakistan, Afghanistan, Iran, Armenian and Georgian Republics (of the U. S. S. R.), Moscow, Germany (both East and West), Belgium, France, London and finally New York and Washington. In Paris they offered Satyagraha to drive home to General de Gaulle the dangerous French folly of not signing the partial Test Ban Treaty.

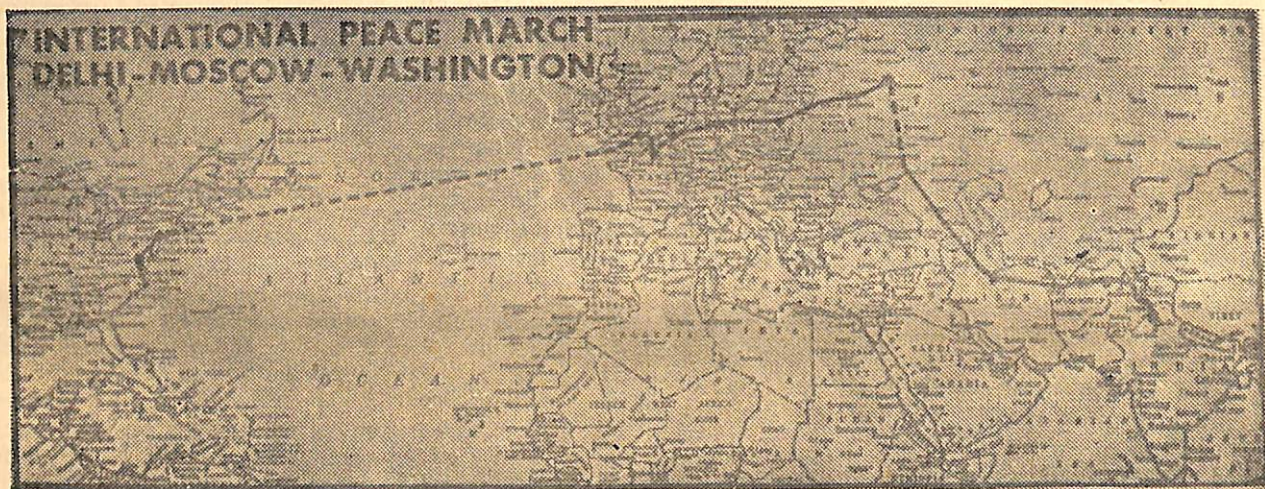
In Washington they laid their triumph cards, in the fitness of things, at the memorial of late President Kennedy, the great martyr for peace.

Menon and Satish are likely to launch a second phase of their remarkable Peace March in Japan before returning to India.

We extend to them our warmest greetings on the fulfilment of a great mission—Ed.

By
JOHN PAPWORTH

Peace Journey's End



At 3 p.m. on Monday, January 6th, two young Indians arrived at the gate of the White House, in Washington. They had left Delhi on the 1st of June 1962 after months of planning, and in response to the call made by Bertrand Russell from the police court at his trial in 1961. Russell had urged people to act for peace and not leave things to politicians. Both Prabhakar Menon and Satish Kumar had certainly acted. Apart from inevitable sea journeys and an air-lift in parts of snow-bound Russia, plus a deportation journey from Paris to Dover, every inch of the way had been covered on foot. By resolving neither to carry nor accept money the walkers had ensured that their primary objective of making contact with people was achieved.

Nobody meeting these two young Indians can fail to be impressed with the personal qualities they have brought to their task. Their flair for languages has helped (both now speak Russian and English and only one of them knew these languages before leaving India), both are born

diplomats with a spontaneous charm of manner which works wonders in disarming the suspicions of strangers, and both, under their gentleness and friendliness, have a will of iron in relation to their peace work. It is easy to see how their venture may have failed at various points either by sheer failure of resolve to carry on through difficulties of climate or of frontier formalities or through misunderstandings with their hosts en route. For the most part they appear to have charmed their way across frontiers and to have left behind them a trail of newly formed friendships with many different people.

Now in Washington they are planning a lecture tour of the United States and Canada, protests to the French Embassy about the gauntlet of thermonuclear war that General de Gaulle has flung into the face of mankind with his new year speech, a peace march from Tokyo to Nagasaki, and a goodwill visit to China.

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